Will Israel get a new government?

A probabilistic assessment of coalition formation after the October 27, 2026 election, with projections to 24 months

DBbun LLC | Uri Kartoun, PhD | October 31, 2026

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Key findings

This report combines three sources: a computer simulation of the coalition talks built by DBbun LLC (Section 5), the history of recent Israeli elections, and estimates from four AI reviewers.

- **No bloc has the 61 seats needed for a majority.** Netanyahu's bloc has 53, the Zionist opposition 48 and the Arab parties 19 [1,4,5].
- **DBbun LLC's pooled estimate:** 54% for a fresh election before a new government is sworn in, and 46% that a government is sworn in. The three sources put the chance of an election between 40% and 67%, so these figures are best read as ranges, not exact forecasts.
- **Netanyahu remains prime minister, as caretaker, unless another government is sworn in.** DBbun LLC's simulation (Section 5) gives 84% that he is prime minister at 3 months, 73% at 12 months and 70% at 24 months. The AI reviewers' average is 81%, 60% and 51%. In the simulation, a new government is in office by 6, 12 and 24 months with probability 38%, 60% and 72%.
- **Among the scenarios tested, three developments move the numbers most:** a credible Likud alternative to Netanyahu, Avigdor Liberman accepting outside Arab-party support, and a Haredi draft-service deal.

1. Summary

The Central Elections Committee's final count gives Likud 27 seats, Yashar 21, Together (B'Yachad) 12, the Joint List 11, the Democrats 8, Ra'am 8, United Torah Judaism 7, Yisrael Beytenu 7, Otzma Yehudit 7, Religious Zionism 6 and Shas 6. Turnout was 77.9 percent, the highest in decades, and Arab-party representation rose from

10 to 19 seats [1,6]. Netanyahu's bloc fell from 68 seats at its peak in the outgoing Knesset to 53 [1,7,13]. Official results go to the President on November 4. Netanyahu remains prime minister of a caretaker government until another government is formed [5,7].

Seats by bloc

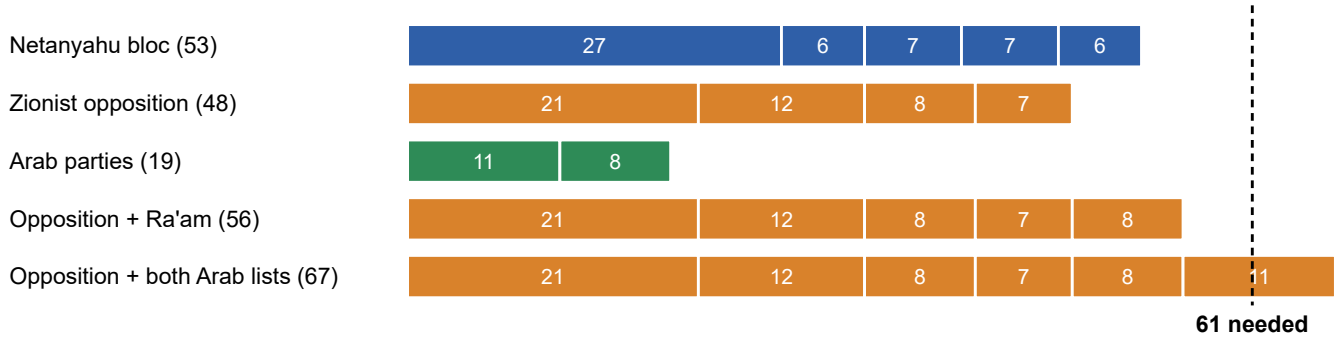


Figure 1. Seats by bloc and the 61-seat majority line. Netanyahu bloc: Likud 27, UTJ 7, Otzma Yehudit 7, Shas 6, Religious Zionism 6. Opposition: Yashar 21, Together 12, Democrats 8, Yisrael Beytenu 7. Arab parties: Joint List 11, Ra'am 8. Source: [1], DBbun LLC arithmetic.

2. Why the arithmetic is not enough

Each of the 11 parties can be inside or outside a coalition, which gives 2,048 possible combinations; leaving out the empty one leaves 2,047. Adding up the seats in each combination, 1,000 of them reach 61 or more, but most are politically impossible. The real question is which red lines will move. The opposition reaches 56 with Ra'am and 67 with both Arab lists, yet most of its Jewish parties pledged not to rely on Arab parties [5,8,11]. Netanyahu's bloc plus Yisrael Beytenu would reach only 60, and Liberman refuses to join him even in a rotation [5]. Three combinations reach exactly 61: Likud, Yashar, UTJ and Shas; the Netanyahu bloc with Ra'am; and Yashar, Together, Democrats, Yisrael Beytenu, UTJ and Shas (a Jewish-only majority without Likud). Likud, Yashar and Together reach 60. A government needs more votes for than against when it is sworn in, not 61 in favor, so abstentions matter [3,5]. Other steps use other thresholds: asking the President to name a candidate needs 61 signatures, and replacing a government by a vote of no confidence needs a majority behind an alternative government [14].

3. Stated positions (as reported)

Actor	Reported position	Source
Netanyahu / Likud	Seeks a strong right-wing government; stays caretaker prime minister meanwhile.	[5,11]
Eisenkot (Yashar)	Will not sit under Netanyahu; pledged not to partner with Arab parties.	[4,5,8]
Bennett (Together)	Pledged not to sit in a government with Netanyahu; opposed relying on Arab parties.	[4,5]
Liberman (Yisrael Beytenu)	Refuses to join Netanyahu even in a rotation; opposed Eisenkot's minority-government idea; says his party will work to replace the Speaker and pass the “Indictee Law”.	[5,15]
Golan (Democrats)	The only leader in the four-party Zionist opposition bloc urging partnership with Arab parties.	[5,8]
Ra'am, Joint List	Leaders said they would help oust Netanyahu. That is not agreement to back a particular government. Ra'am sat in the 2021 government.	[5,7]
UTJ (Haredi)	Reported (†) to consider outside support for an Eisenkot-led government; chair denies contacts. Draft exemption is a make-or-break demand.	[4,12†]
Ben Gvir, Smotrich, Shas	No stated positions found in the sources reviewed. This is a gap in coverage, not evidence of flexibility.	—

4. The legal calendar

Step	Date (latest)	Source
Official results delivered to President Herzog	Nov 4, 2026 (expected)	[1,3,6]
New Knesset sworn in	Nov 10, 2026	[1,2]
President assigns first mandate (within 7 days of publication)	Nov 11	[14]
First candidate: 28 days, extendable by up to 14 in total	Dec 23	[14]
President decides within 3 days; second candidate: 28 days, no extension	Jan 23, 2027	[14]
President announces; a majority of MKs (61) may request one consenting candidate within 21 days; President assigns within 2 days; 14 days to form	Mar 4, 2027	[14]
Government presents to the Knesset for confidence within 7 days of notification	—	[14]
If all fail: Knesset is dispersed and elections are held on the last Tuesday before the end of 90 days from the President's announcement	late spring 2027	[4,14]

Dates are DBbun LLC's calculations from the deadlines in Basic Law: The Government [14], assuming results are published on November 4 and each stage uses its full time; stages can end earlier. AP expects new elections early next year if talks fail [4]. The Knesset can also dissolve itself by law at any time.†

5. Probability of each outcome

The assessment covers the formation process that follows the October 27 election and ends when a government is sworn in or a fresh election is triggered. The five outcomes are mutually exclusive and cover every case: (1) fresh election before a new government; (2) minority government without Likud (outside support or abstention); (3) government with Netanyahu as prime minister or designated rotation prime minister; (4) government including Likud without Netanyahu in either role; (5) majority coalition of 61 or more without Likud.

Outcome	DBbun LLC simulation	AI reviewer panel (average)	Pooled estimate
Fresh election	67%	54%	**54%**
Minority government without Likud	5%	17%	**12%**
Netanyahu-led government (or rotation)	19%	19%	**22%**
Likud government without Netanyahu	8%	7%	**9%**
Majority government without Likud	1%	3%	**3%**

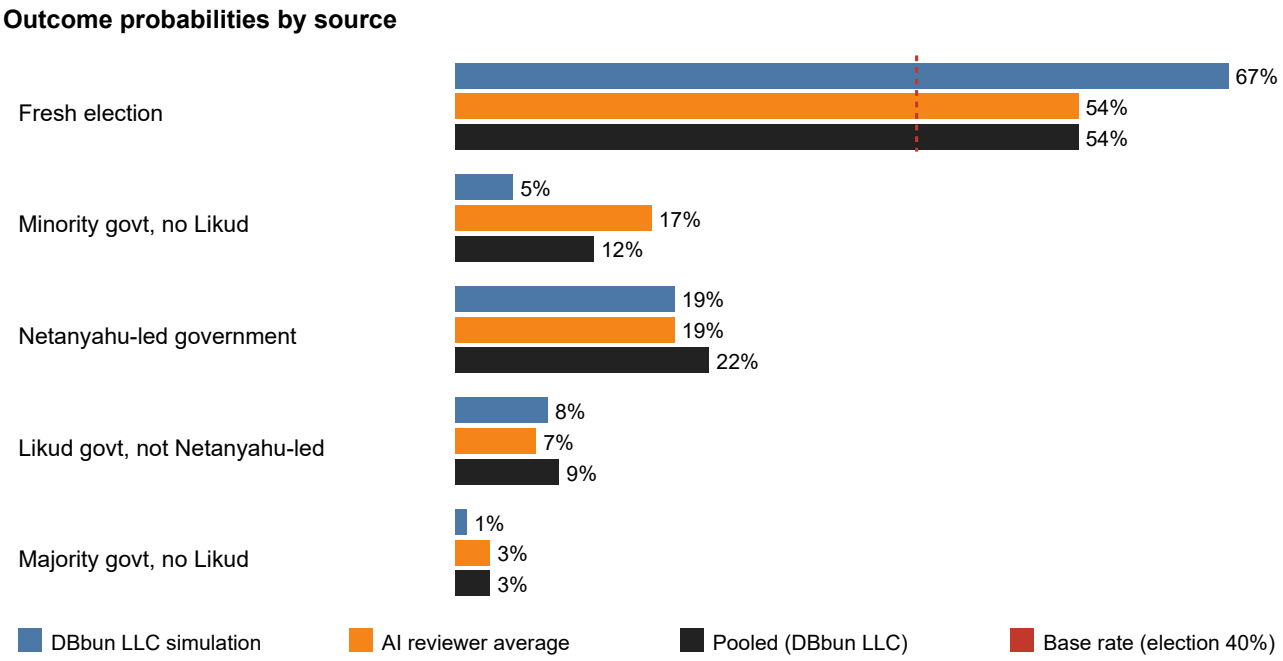


Figure 2. Outcome probabilities by source. The dashed line marks the historical base rate for a fresh election (2 of 5 elections in 2019–2022 ended without a government, 40%) [4,10].

How the numbers were built. The estimate combines three views, each with equal weight on the main question: will there be a fresh election or a new government? (a) A computer simulation built by DBbun LLC for this report. It plays out many possible rounds of coalition talks, in which each party can back a candidate, stay neutral or oppose, and pressure grows as attempts fail. It gives a fresh election 67%. (b) History: of the five elections in 2019–2022, two ended without a government (40%). (c) Four AI reviewers were asked for their own estimates (Table 5b). On average they gave 54%. They made their estimates after reading an earlier version of this report, so they may have been influenced by it. The three views are averaged: (67 + 40 + 54) / 3 = 54%. The remaining 46% is shared among the four government outcomes in proportion to what the simulation and the reviewers each suggest. The weights are a judgment call. The gap between the views (40% to 67%) is the honest measure of how uncertain this is.

Reviewer	Election	Minority	Netanyahu-led	Likud w/o Netanyahu	Majority w/o Likud	Netanyahu is prime minister after			
						3 mo	6 mo	12 mo	24 mo
Grok	55%	18%	18%	5%	4%	80%	68%	58%	52%
Gemini	52%	16%	22%	7%	3%	82%	68%	56%	50%
Claude	55%	13%	17%	12%	3%	78%	73%	60%	50%
GPT	55%	20%	18%	5%	2%	85%	80%	65%	50%
Average	**54%**	**17%**	**19%**	**7%**	**3%**	**81%**	**72%**	**60%**	**51%**

Table 5b. Estimates by four AI reviewers (percent), made before critiquing the report. Averages in the last row.

6. Projection: 3, 6, 9, 12 months and beyond

The projection plays the process forward month by month: it follows the legal deadlines, lets governments fall at assumed rates, and repeats elections when talks fail. Months are counted from November 11, 2026 (3 months is about February 2027; 12 months about November 2027). In its first round the simulation is set to match the pooled estimate above. Netanyahu counts as prime minister while he leads a caretaker government. In Figure 3 the diamonds show the AI reviewers' average. The simulation is more favorable to Netanyahu at 12 and 24 months (73% and 70%, against 60% and 51%), because it assumes new elections would leave the blocs about the size they are now.

State of play	3 mo	6 mo	9 mo	12 mo	18 mo	24 mo
Interim: talks continue, Netanyahu caretaker	63%	2%	42%	5%	8%	10%
Knesset dissolved, campaign under way	2%	60%	6%	35%	22%	17%
Netanyahu-led government in office	18%	20%	28%	33%	40%	43%
Non-Likud government in office (Eisenkot or another opposition leader)	13%	11%	17%	18%	20%	20%
Likud government without Netanyahu	4%	7%	7%	9%	10%	9%
Any new government in office	**34%**	**38%**	**52%**	**60%**	**70%**	**72%**

How to read the table: the legal calendar drives the swings. Around month 6 most paths are in an election campaign; by month 9 a new round of talks follows that election. Netanyahu is prime minister in the first three rows. Percentages are rounded, so totals can differ from 100% or from other tables by one point.

Who is prime minister over time

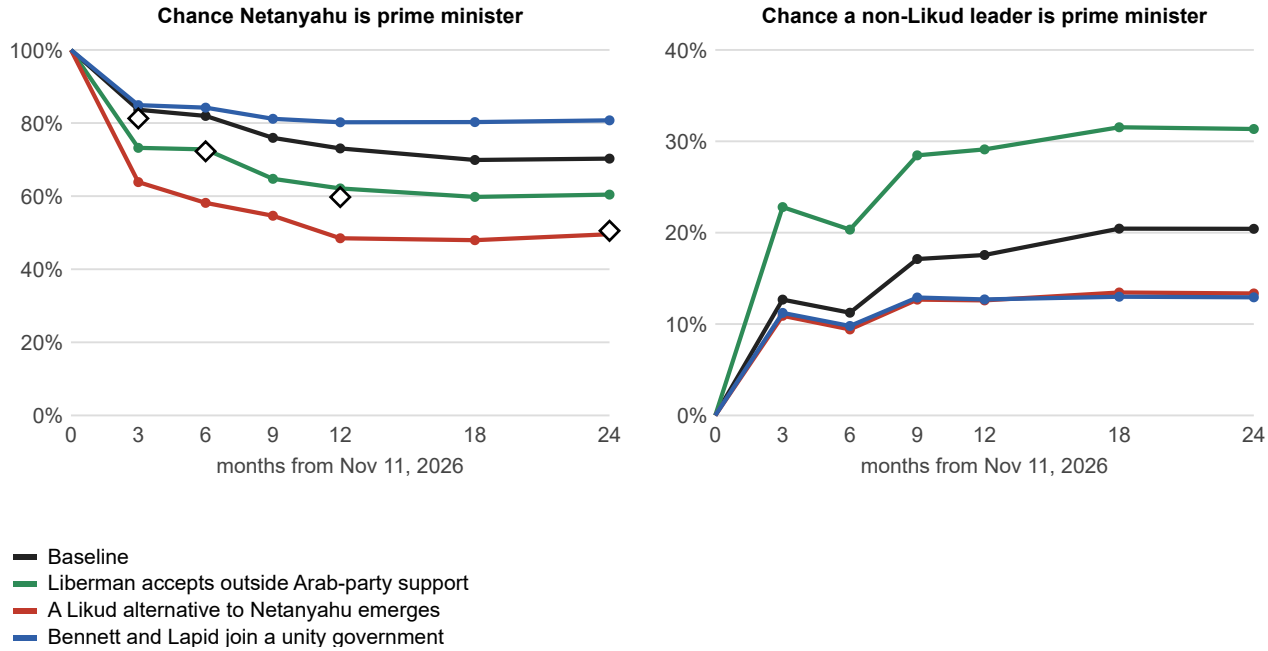


Figure 3. Probability that Netanyahu (left) or a non-Likud leader such as Eisenkot (right) is prime minister: baseline and three what-if scenarios. Simulated projections, not observations. Diamonds: AI reviewers' average.

7. What-if scenarios

Scenario	Netanyahu is prime minister			A non-Likud leader is prime minister		
	6 mo	12 mo	24 mo	6 mo	12 mo	24 mo
Baseline (current positions)	82%	73%	70%	11%	18%	20%
Iran war resumes: security pressure pushes parties toward unity [9]	81%	75%	75%	11%	16%	17%
Liberman accepts, and Ra'am and the Joint List provide, outside Arab-party support for an Eisenkot-led government	73%	62%	60%	20%	29%	31%
Haredi draft-service deal moves UTJ and Shas	75%	64%	62%	18%	27%	29%
A credible Likud alternative to Netanyahu emerges	58%	48%	50%	9%	13%	13%
Bennett and Lapid join a unity government with Netanyahu	84%	80%	81%	10%	13%	13%
Pressure held constant: no learning from failed attempts	84%	74%	70%	10%	16%	20%

Among the scenarios tested, only a Likud alternative to Netanyahu cuts his chance of being prime minister to about one-half. The path most helpful to a non-Likud prime minister is outside Arab-party support accepted by Liberman, which adds roughly ten points. A resumed Iran war changes little because it raises pressure on both

sides. Governments that do form are fragile: the projection assumes a minority government lasts about 14 months on average, a non-Likud majority government or a Likud government without Netanyahu about 22, and a Netanyahu-led government about 33. These are judgments informed by history: the 35th government lasted about seven months and the 36th about twelve [10].

8. What would change the estimate

Observable evidence	Likely effect
Liberman publicly accepts outside Arab-party support or abstention	Raises minority-government outcome, lowers fresh election
Haredi leadership signs a binding draft-service framework	Opens a UTJ/Shas path; test each faction separately
Named Likud successor with a countable group of supporters	Sharply raises Likud-without-Netanyahu outcome
Bennett, Lapid or Eisenkot publicly drop the pledge against Netanyahu	Raises Netanyahu-led or unity outcome
Joint List commits to vote against a given government	Hurts minority paths that rely on its abstention
Opposition and Arab MKs jointly pass a Knesset leadership vote or law	Shows coordination capacity, not coalition agreement
Repeated failure after public concessions	Raises fresh election; incumbent keeps waiting advantage

What the projections leave out. The President's choices: officials say the first mandate will not necessarily go to the largest party, and President Herzog urges avoiding another election [16]. Pressure in the Knesset without a government: the opposition and Arab parties together hold a majority, and Liberman says they will move to replace the Speaker and advance the “Indictee Law” (the source does not describe its content) [15]. The Knesset could also dissolve itself by law (†). Netanyahu's ongoing trial [4]. Splits inside parties and individual MKs changing sides.

9. Method, limits and disclosure

Limits. These are judgments, partly based on a simulation, not poll results or a proven forecast. The simulation's assumptions about each party were not tested against past data. Anonymous reports are treated as possibilities, not agreements. Reports that repeat one original story are not independent confirmations. Security, legal or personal events can change incentives quickly. The main estimates cover forming a government in this round; Sections 6 and 7 look further ahead under stated assumptions.

Sources. Seat counts follow the Central Elections Committee figures reported in [1] and [2]. † marks items taken from headlines or search summaries only. No original polling or confidential negotiation data was used.

AI disclosure. This report was prepared with Claude Code (Anthropic), including analysis, writing and translation. A separate analysis was produced with GPT (OpenAI). The report was then reviewed independently by Grok (xAI), Gemini (Google), Claude (Anthropic) and GPT (OpenAI). Their estimates are used in Section 5, their comments led to corrections, and none of them endorses the result. The English and Hebrew versions have identical content.

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Method in detail: how the simulation works

1. Starting assumptions. For each possible candidate (an Eisenkot-led government, a Netanyahu-led government, or a Likud government without Netanyahu), each of the 11 parties is given a starting chance of voting for, abstaining or voting against. These come from the public positions in Section 3. They are DBbun LLC's judgments, not measured data. The table below lists them for the first two candidates; for a Likud government without Netanyahu, Yashar, Together and Yisrael Beytenu are assumed likelier to back it.

2. Uncertainty. Before each batch of runs, every assumption is shifted slightly up or down at random, so the results reflect that the assumptions themselves are uncertain.

3. Pressure to compromise. A shared pressure factor is drawn for each run and rises with every failed attempt, so parties become likelier to abstain or back a candidate as deadlines pass. In some runs a security shock, such as renewed war with Iran, adds further pull toward unity.

4. Three attempts. Following the legal calendar in Section 4, a first candidate tries, then a second, then 61 members may back one candidate. In each attempt every party's vote is drawn from its chances. A government forms if more members vote for than against (in the last stage, if at least 61 vote for).

5. Repeat elections. If all attempts fail, an election is held. Seat totals are drawn close to today's results (Netanyahu's bloc about 54 give or take 4, the opposition 48 give or take 3.5, the Arab parties 18 give or take 2.5). A bloc that reaches 61 forms a government; otherwise talks start again, with more pressure each round.

6. Falling governments. Once formed, a government can fall in any month at the assumed rates given in Section 7. A fall leads to a new election.

7. Number of runs. Each scenario is run 60,000 times (120 sets of assumptions, 500 runs each). The shares of runs that end in each outcome, month by month, are the percentages reported.

8. Matching the pooled estimate. In the first round, four settings (overall pressure; the willingness of six parties to back an Eisenkot-led government; the willingness of three parties to back a Netanyahu-led one; and the chance that a Likud alternative to Netanyahu emerges) were adjusted until the simulation closely reproduced the outcome shares in Table 5. The same settings are used for every later month and every scenario.

9. What-if scenarios. Each scenario in Section 7 changes only the assumptions named there.

Party	Eisenkot-led government (%)			Netanyahu-led government (%)		
	For	Abstain	Against	For	Abstain	Against
Likud	0	0	100	100	0	0
Yashar	100	0	0	2	3	95
Together	75	10	15	5	5	90
Joint List	5	40	55	0	2	98
Democrats	97	2	1	0	0	100
Ra'am	30	55	15	1	9	90
UTJ	5	15	80	88	8	4
Yisrael Beytenu	15	15	70	2	3	95
Otzma Yehudit	0	0	100	90	5	5
Religious Zionism	0	0	100	90	5	5
Shas	1	4	95	93	5	2

Starting assumptions, before the random adjustments and the rise in pressure. DBbun LLC judgments.

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